

# Applying Functional Medicine in Clinical Practice

## *Introduction*



**KELECHI A. UDUHIRI, MD**

**APPLYING FUNCTIONAL MEDICINE IN CLINICAL PRACTICE**

# Disclosures

**Kelechi A. Uduhiri, MD** disclosed no relevant financial relationships with any ineligible companies.

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# *Clinical Focus*

- Brief overview of IFM's introductory course: Applying Functional Medicine in Clinical Practice (AFMCP).



# The Functional Medicine Clinical Method



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## GOTOIT

*The sequence of steps used in the practice  
of functional medicine:*

| GOTOIT Step and Definition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | IFM Tools (examples)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Clinical Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>G – GATHER</b> oneself with a brief personal practice prior to prepare for each patient encounter.<br>Take a detailed functional medicine history that includes the essential health events and features of a patient's life documented on the IFM Timeline in the process of organizing the patient's data.                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Cultivating Self Awareness and Mindfulness</li> <li>Adult Intake Form</li> <li>Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ)</li> <li>PROMIS Questionnaires</li> <li>Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal</li> <li>Functional Medicine Tree</li> <li>Functional Medicine Timeline</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Use the <b>Cultivating Self-Awareness and Mindfulness</b> document to help gather yourself before every patient encounter.</li> <li>The <b>Adult Intake Form</b> is used to gather initial intake information. Whereas, the <b>MSQ</b>, <b>PROMIS Questionnaires</b>, and <b>Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal</b> help gather initial symptom, function, and dietary information.</li> <li>Map root causes (antecedents, triggers, mediators (ATMs)) and effects (clinical findings, current concerns) of physiological dysfunction on the <b>Functional Medicine Timeline</b>.</li> </ul> |
| <b>O – ORGANIZE</b> the data gathered in the previous step and document them on the IFM Timeline and Matrix to identify the personalized root causes of current concerns, dysfunctions, and conditions, and to begin to prioritize the order (sequence) of interventions.                                                                                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Functional Medicine Tree</li> <li>Functional Medicine Timeline</li> <li>Functional Medicine Matrix</li> <li>Adult Intake Form</li> <li>Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ)</li> <li>PROMIS Questionnaires</li> <li>Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal</li> </ul>                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Using the <b>Functional Medicine Matrix</b>, populate ATMs, clinical findings, and current concerns from the Timeline. Add modifiable lifestyle factors (MLFs) and mental, emotional, spiritual factors (MES) to support the identification of the most important areas of physiological dysfunction.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>T – TELL</b> the life story back to the patient to ensure accuracy and a shared understanding.<br>This dialogue, focused on the Timeline, highlights how factors elicited in the Gather step may have contributed to current or future clinical findings, concerns, health status and trajectory.<br>The patient is asked to join in correcting the story, engendering a context of true partnership. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Functional Medicine Matrix</li> <li>Functional Medicine Timeline</li> <li>Functional Medicine Tree</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The <b>Functional Medicine Timeline</b> is used to re-tell the patient's story while correlating prior events and root causes with current concerns or conditions. Ask the patient to join in for corrections or additional context.</li> <li>Use the <b>Functional Medicine Tree</b> to explain how the root causes have contributed to the patient's condition.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

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| GOTOIT Step and Definition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | IFM Tools (examples)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Clinical Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>O – ORDER</b> and collaboratively prioritize the most feasible and effective interventions by taking antecedents, triggers, mediators, and patient contextual factors into account.                                                                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Functional Medicine Matrix</li> <li>Readiness for Change</li> <li>Goal Setting for Behavior Change</li> <li>Integrating Guided Imagery and Visualization to Achieve Personal Health Goals</li> </ul>                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Using the <b>Functional Medicine Matrix</b>, co-prioritize the areas of physiological dysfunction.</li> <li>Assess if the patient is ready and committed to making changes with the <b>Readiness for Change</b> document. Use the <b>Goal Setting for Behavior Change</b> document to determine the patient's goals, values, preferences, and priorities. Then set SMART goals for interventions.</li> </ul>  |
| <b>I – INITIATE</b> Initiate interventions based on collaborative prioritization:<br>1) Evaluative, diagnostic, and prognostic testing.<br>2) Referral to another member of the collaborative care team for further assessment, intervention, or support.<br>3) Therapeutic interventions. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Functional Medicine Tree</li> <li>Functional Medicine Matrix</li> <li>Functional Medicine Timeline</li> <li>Goal Setting for Behavior Change</li> <li>Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The <b>Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan</b> helps layout the therapeutic plan. This may include removing or reducing triggers, modifying lifestyle and dietary mediators, addressing gut health and function, implementing other therapeutic interventions, ordering appropriate laboratory tests, or referring as needed.</li> </ul>                                                      |
| <b>T – TRACK</b> and monitor the effectiveness of, and adherence to, the initiated interventions as well as interval life events and changes in the patient's circumstances.                                                                                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Medical Symptoms Questionnaire (MSQ)</li> <li>PROMIS Questionnaires</li> <li>Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal</li> </ul>                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Use tools to track progress by comparing scores at subsequent visits. The <b>MSQ</b> helps track symptom trajectory, the <b>PROMIS Questionnaires</b> help track overall well-being and quality of life, and the <b>Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal</b> helps track adherence to regimen.</li> <li>There are many other tools and questionnaires that can be helpful for tracking progress.</li> </ul> |

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# Long Description: The Functional Medicine Clinical Method

- Toolkit item – the G O T O I T Model: the sequence of steps used in the practice of functional medicine.

# Foundational Therapeutic Approach: Lifestyle – Nutrition – Gut Function

# Foundational Therapeutic Approach:

## Lifestyle – Nutrition – Gut Function



**LIFESTYLE FIRST**

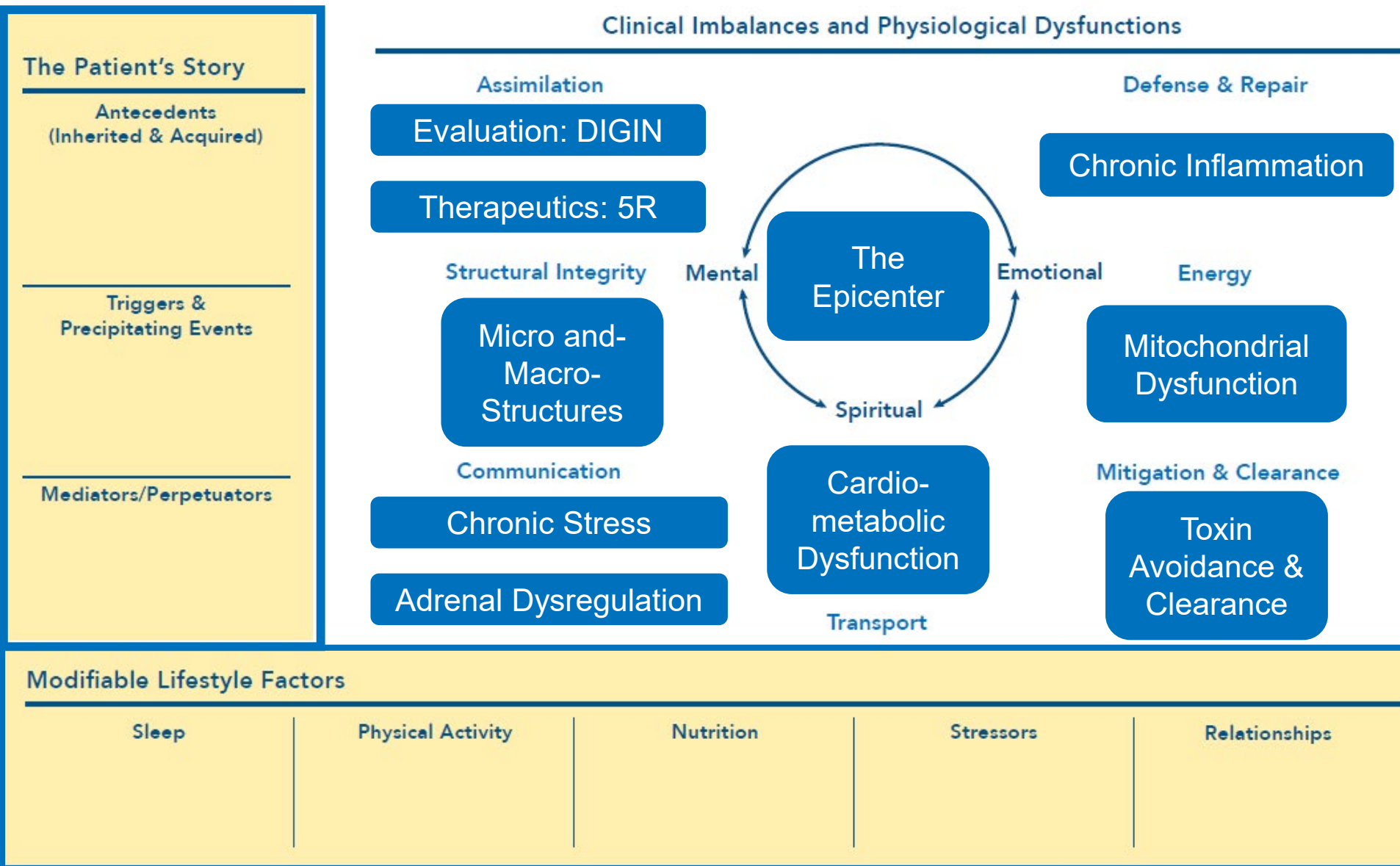


**FOOD FIRST**



**GUT FIRST**

# Functional Medicine Matrix





# Long Description: Functional Medicine Matrix

- The Functional Medicine Matrix with an emphasis on Clinical Imbalances and Physiological Dysfunctions.
- Assimilation: Evaluation: D I G I N; Therapeutics: 5 R
- Defense and Repair: Chronic Inflammation
- Energy: Mitochondrial Dysfunction
- Mitigation and Clearance: Toxin Avoidance and Clearance
- Transport: Cardio-metabolic Dysfunction
- Communication: Chronic Stress and Adrenal Dysregulation
- Structural Integrity: Micro and Macro Structures
- Mental, Emotional, and Spiritual: The Epicenter

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